

PRACHI SHUKLA

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Sanford School of Public Policy
201 Science Dr
Durham, NC 27708

EDUCATION

Duke University

2022-Present

PhD Public Policy (Economics), Sanford School of Public Policy
MA Economics, Department of Economics (awarded at graduation)
Committee: Lisa Gennetian (Chair), Marcos Rangel, Erica Field, Sarah Komisarow

London School of Economics and Political Science

2017-18

MSc in Development Studies (Applied Development Economics)

St. Xavier's College, Mumbai

2014-17

BA Economics and Sociology (Minor: Statistics)

WORKS IN PROGRESS

Alcohol Access and Household Welfare: Evidence from India's Highway Liquor Ban

This paper studies India's 2017 highway liquor ban, which prohibited liquor outlets within a fixed distance of national and state highways. I construct treatment intensity using spatial data and combine it with monthly household expenditure data and health outcomes. I find that more exposed households reduce liquor purchases and alcohol expenditure share after the ban, with no corresponding change in total expenditure or total income. I also find significant declines in spending on other temptation goods, including tobacco and snack foods. Despite these reductions in alcohol spending and a significant increase in female labour force participation, reported intimate partner violence increases, particularly among poorer and rural households.

Inheritance Rights, Dowry, and the Indian Marriage Market

Daughters in rural India are compensated either through inheritance or through dowry at marriage. I show that sibling composition drives the choice: daughters with more brothers get less land and more dowry. Exploiting staggered state amendments to the Hindu Succession Act, I find the reform raised daughters' inheritance; however, daughters with more brothers continued to face a penalty in equal inheritance.

Primary School Expansion and Girls' Life Trajectories: Long-Run Evidence from India

I study the long-run impacts of India's District Primary Education Programme (DPEP)—the world's largest school expansion initiative launched in the 1990s. Using a district-by-cohort difference-in-differences design, I find substantial and persistent gains in schooling among girls, as well as delayed marriage, lower fertility, and stronger natal family linkages.

De Jure Policy Design and De Facto Implementation of Cash Assistance Programs: Evidence of Differential Receipt among Latino Families

With Lisa Gennetian, Marcos Rangel, Dana Thomson, Christina Padilla, Luis Basurto.

https://papers.ssrn.com/sol3/papers.cfm?abstract_id=675759

Heterogeneous Receipt of Social Assistance Programs Among Families with Low Income in the U.S.: The Role of State Policy Design

With Lisa Gennetian, Marcos Rangel, Dana Thomson, Luis Basurto, Haocheng Yong.

https://papers.ssrn.com/sol3/papers.cfm?abstract_id=712130

NGOs in India - where they work and what they do

With Sanjana Kadyan and Sai Pitre.

PAPERS

Shukla, P., & Srivastava, P. (2021). *The crisis behind closed doors: Domestic workers' struggles during the pandemic and beyond.* Economic & Political Weekly.

PRESENTING

Allied Social Science Associations / American Economic Association Annual Meeting 2027 (scheduled)
Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management Annual Meeting 2024, 2026 (scheduled)
Southern Economic Association Annual Meeting 2024, 2025, 2026 (scheduled)

TEACHING & MENTORING

Co-Instructor: Empirical Methods for Social Progress (Prof Lisa Gennetian, Spring'26)
TA: PUBPOL810 Microeconomics and Public Policy-Making (Dr Matthew Johnson, Fall'25)
TA: Workshops in Economics and Mathematics for incoming Masters in Public Policy (Fall'25, Fall'26)
Head TA: PUBPOL303 Microeconomic Policy Tools (Prof Lisa Gennetian, Spring'24)
Mentor for Economics Mentoring Program (joint Duke, Harvard, MIT, and Stanford)

GRANTS AND FELLOWSHIPS

von der Heyden Global Fellowship - \$64,861
APPAM Equity & Inclusion Fellowship 2025 - *value over \$1,000*
Summer Research Fellowship for Research on Women and Girls of Color (2025) - \$10,000
Duke India Initiative Graduate Student Grant (2024) - \$2,000
Sanford Research and Travel Small Grant (2022, 2023, 2024, 2025) - \$1,000 each

AWARDS

Royal Society of Arts	Nominated and accepted as a Fellow (2020)
St. Xavier's College, Mumbai	First rank in Economics, Sociology and Statistics (2017)

PREVIOUS WORK EXPERIENCE

World Bank <i>Consultant, Development Impact Evaluation</i>	May 2021 - July 2022 <i>New Delhi & Mumbai, India</i>
Jameel Poverty Action Lab (J-PAL) <i>Research Associate to Dr Erin Kelley</i>	April 2019 - April 2021 <i>Mumbai, India</i>
Save the Children International <i>Award (Grant) Management Intern</i>	July 2018 - January 2019 <i>London, UK</i>
Reserve Bank of India <i>Intern, International Department's G20 Division</i>	July 2017 - September 2017 <i>Mumbai, India</i>
NITI Aayog (erstwhile Planning Commission of India) <i>Intern to the CEO, Mr Amitabh Kant</i>	June 2017 - July 2017 <i>Mumbai, India</i>
K.C. Mahindra Education Trust <i>Intern</i>	May 2016 <i>Mumbai, India</i>
Teach for India <i>Volunteer Teaching Assistant</i>	August 2014 - March 2015 <i>Mumbai, India</i>

ADDITIONAL WRITING

Published an [article](#) for the LSE International Development Blog on the increase in domestic violence cases as a result of the stay-at-home orders

Published a [book review](#) for the LSE Review of Books on *Data Feminism* (MIT Press) by Prof Catherine D'Ignazio (MIT DUSP) and Prof Laura Klein (Emory University)

TECHNICAL STRENGTHS

R, Stata, SurveyCTO, L^AT_EX